that revolutionary transition from hunter-gathering and nomadic pastoralism to settled cultivation, placing them among the world's earliest farmers.

2 Charles Masson, *Narrative of Various Journeys in Balochistan, Afghanistan and the Panjab*, 1843.

3 In fact, Banerji was beaten to it by a young Italian linguist named Luigi Pio Tessitori, who in 1919 recovered three Harappan seals at the now well-known site of Kalibangan on the southern banks of the Ghaggar River in Rajasthan. However, luck was not on Tessitori's side. He caught the prevalent Spanish flu and died in Bikaner in November 1919. Excavations began in earnest at Kalibangan only in 1960 but little was published on the Kalibangan excavations until 2003 – a foot-dragging repeated all too often at other archaeological sites. See Nayanjot Lahiri, *Finding Forgotten Cities: How the Indus Civilization was Discovered*, 2012.

4 Sir John Marshall, *ASI Annual Report 1923-34*, 1934.

5 A number of cuneiform tablets excavated in Iraq refer to trade links with a country named Meluhha or Melukhkha which has been taken to refer to the Harappans. Some scholars have linked the word to the Sanskrit *mleccha* ('foreigners'), while others have suggested a link with the Dravidian word *mel akam*, meaning 'high country', which seems perverse considering that the great cities of the Harappans were mostly confined to the plains. Even so, the significance of the name Meluhha has in recent years been elevated to a ridiculous degree.

6 A recent much-touted claim for a seal depicting the rear end of a horse has been shown to be based on a combination of photoshopping and an over-active imagination. Similarly, a number of supposed horse skeletons have been shown to be linked to the Indian wild ass. See Michael Witzel and Steve Farmer, 'Horseplay at Harappa', *Frontline*, Vol. 17, Issue 20, Sep-Oct 2000, with subsequent articles, including their